But if we assume that Kim Jong-un will be guided by his survival instinct, he might read Trump as follows:

- Trump wants to kill terrorists and does not want to get involved in major wars.
- Trump enjoys the support of only a minority of Americans. The American majority finds him repugnant, as do the American media.
- Trump is a serial violator of international agreements. These include the Trans-Pacific Partnership, of which twelve countries are members, and the Paris Agreement on climate change, signed by 195 countries. He maintains a hostile attitude toward NATO, whose members believe America can no longer be trusted, and finally, he pulled out of the nuclear deal with Iran.

Some of Kim Jong-un's other considerations may be as follows:

- He believes that in situations of brinkmanship, China will continue to support him and will not "throw North Korea to the dogs," because as its buffer state with South Korea, which enjoys the support of the United States, North Korea is a strategic asset that China will not easily give up.
- Russia also has allied itself with North Korea and probably promised it its veto in the UN Security Council, as part of its strategy of obstruction against any American move.
- If the United States withdraws from the nuclear agreement with Iran, all that is left for it to do is impose additional sanctions against Iran, to which the other parties to the agreement will not join. An American attack on Iran's nuclear facilities is inconceivable.

The conclusion that the North Korean leader is likely to reach is that he can continue his show of brinkmanship vis-à-vis Trump, with the exception of a physical attack on American territory (including Guam), without risking a direct American attack on his country. He will not initiate a direct attack on the United States but will respond to any attack by it.

As for the United States, it is quite possible that Kim will succeed in knocking Trump off balance, but if the latter wants to attack, the American